English

Unit 3 – Living Things

WALT: 6Rm.01 Understand, with support, most of the main points of short and extended texts.

6Rm.02 Read independently a range of short, simple fiction and non-fiction texts with confidence and enjoyment.

Homework – Tuesday 3rd November

Next week, you will be creating an infographic.

You need to pick one of these animal types.

- **Birds**
- **Mammals**
- **Insects**
- **Amphibians**
- **Fish**
- **Reptiles**

You need to research how that animal type survives.

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I can read a text.



With support, I can answer questions on a text.



Independently, I can answer questions on a text.

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Retrieval Practice

Question 6

You went to see a concert by your favourite band last night. Write an email to your English friend, Jo.

Say:

- **what** the band is **called**
- **where** the **concert was**
- **why** you **liked** the concert.

Write **25 – 35** words.
Write the email below.

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Read the text by yourself.

Pg. 52 - 54

Song for a Whale

by Lynne Kelly

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who uses sign language to help her understand
Ms. Amarillo.

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As far as anyone knew, it had always been that
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mother was a blue whale, and his father a fin w

"The problem," said the narrator, "is Blue 55's unique voice. Most whales call out at frequencies of thirty-five hertz and lower, while this lonely whale's sounds are at around fifty-five hertz."

Only around 20 hertz off, but it made a big difference. He was speaking a language that only he knew.

"Furthermore, his song is in a unique pattern; even if the other whales can hear him, they don't understand what he is saying. Blue 55 probably can't communicate with his own parents."

My stomach tightened into a ball.
I wanted another whale on the screen to swim up to Blue 55, or at least look at him.

"The strange calls of Blue 55 were first detected by naval sonar in the late 1980s. Marine biologists figured out what was making the sounds and why the whale was all alone in the ocean."

I didn't notice until the words on the screen blu eyes were watery. Mr. Charles handed me a tissu pocket. Maybe I'd sniffled or something.

"Allergies," I signed, without looking away from



The narrator went on to say that researchers from a marine sanctuary had tried to put a tracker on Blue 55, so they could follow his migration pattern, which was also weird and unlike other whales'. They got a sample of his skin to test. That was how they figured out his parents had been different species. But, before they could attach the tracker to him, Blue 55 dove down and swam away. He wouldn't need to resurface for a breath for another twenty minutes. Without a tracker on him, the only way anyone ever knew where he was swimming was from underwater microphones that picked up his song.

I didn't remember standing up, but when the video ended and Ms. Alamilla started talking, I had to look down to see Mr. Charles. Everyone's eyes were on me as I slid back down into my chair. My textbook was on the floor – I must have knocked it off my desk when I stood up. I left it at my feet.

"Can you imagine that?" Ms. Alamilla asked. "Swimming around for all those years, unable to communicate with anyone?"

Yes.

She said something else about frequencies, but I wasn't paying attention anymore. I looked through Mr. Charles, as if I could still see that whale on the screen.

Blue 55 didn't have a pod of friends or a family who spoke his language. But he still sang. He was calling and calling, but no one heard him.



Glossary

tracker: a small device to record information about activity

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Song for a Whale

by Lynne Kelly

The narrator of the story is a young girl called Iris, who is deaf. In this extract, Iris is in class with her interpreter, Mr. Charles, who uses sign language to help her understand her teacher, Ms. Amarillo.



The video started out with a whale swimming in the ocean. Because of the captions, I could read the words on the screen instead of from Mr. Charles's hands. The dark gray-blue body of the whale filled up the screen, his tail waving up and down.

The narrator in the video talked about a whale called Blue 55, who swam around by himself and not in a **pod**, like other whales. As far as anyone knew, it had always been that way; he didn't have any friends or a family to swim with or talk to. He was a type of baleen whale – the type that ate **plankton** and small fish, not the kind with teeth that ate squid and seals. But he was a **hybrid**. His mother was a blue whale, and his father a fin whale.

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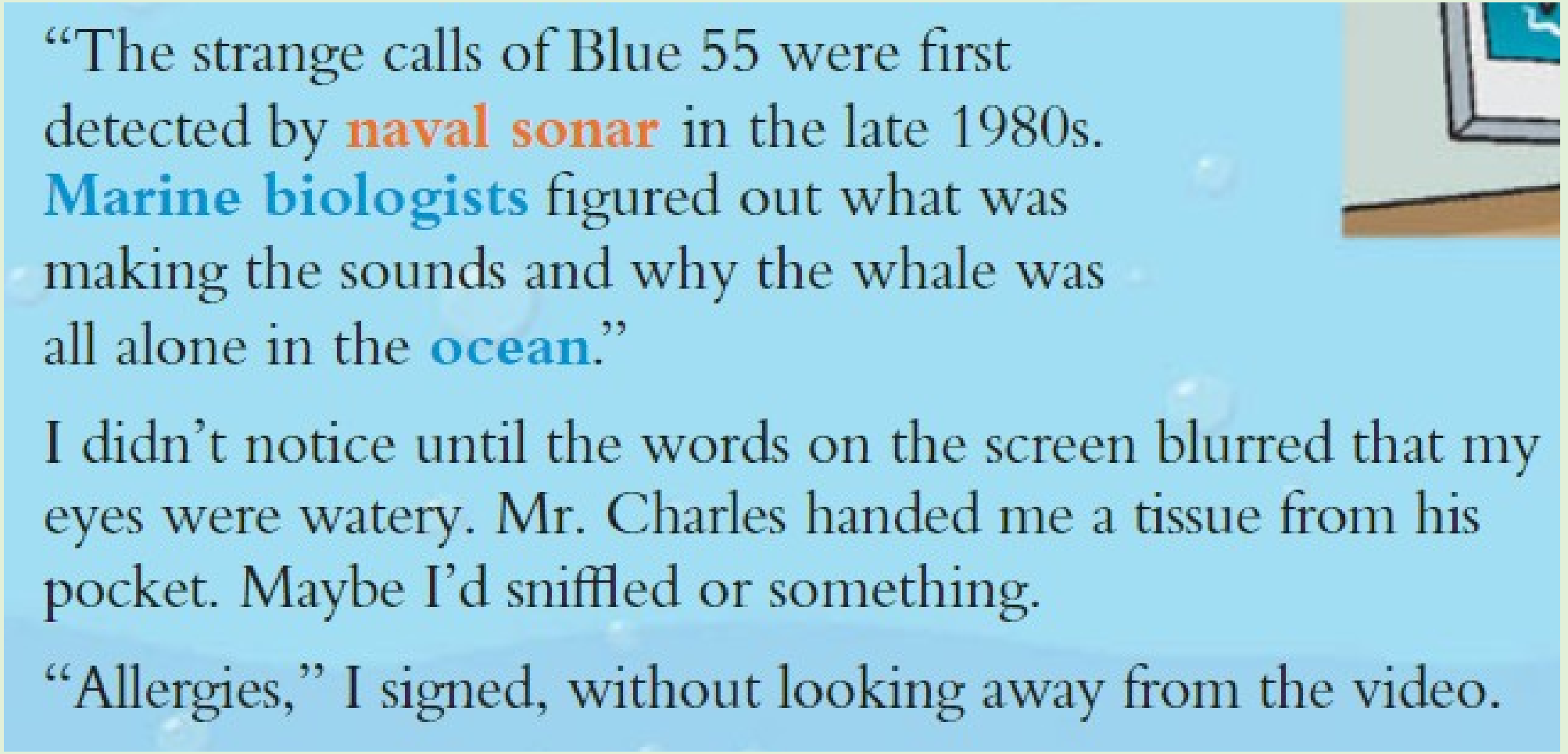
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"The strange calls of Blue 55 were first detected by **naval sonar** in the late 1980s. **Marine biologists** figured out what was making the sounds and why the whale was all alone in the **ocean**."

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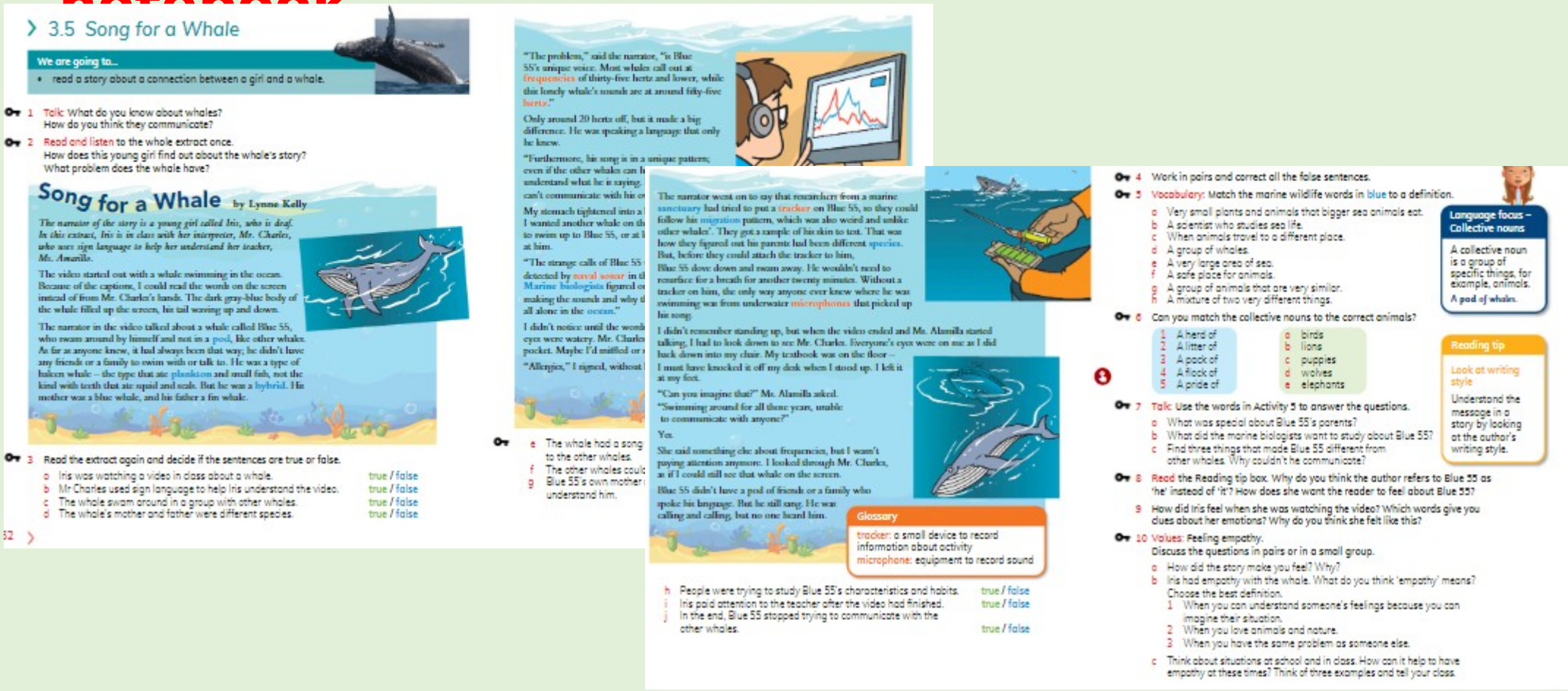
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Answer questions 3 – 10 in your notebook



3.5 Song for a Whale

We are going to...

- read a story about a connection between a girl and a whale.

1 Talk: What do you know about whales?
How do you think they communicate?

2 Read and listen to the whole extract once.
How does this young girl find out about the whale's story?
What problem does the whale have?

Song for a Whale by Lynne Kelly

The narrator of the story is a young girl called Iris, who is deaf. In this extract, Iris is in class with her interpreter, Mr. Charles, who uses sign language to help her understand her teacher, Ms. Amarillo.

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3 Read the extract again and decide if the sentences are true or false.

a Iris was watching a video in class about a whale. true / false
b Mr Charles used sign language to help Iris understand the video. true / false
c The whale swam around in a group with other whales. true / false
d The whale's mother and father were different species. true / false

"The problem," said the narrator, "is Blue 55's unique voice. Most whales call out at frequencies of thirty-five hertz and lower, while this lonely whale's sounds are at around fifty-five hertz."

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I didn't notice until the words ... eyes were watery. Mr. Charles ... pocket. Maybe I'd sniffled or ...

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e The whale had a song ... to the other whales.
f The other whales could ...
g Blue 55's own mother ... understand him.

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Glossary
tracker: a small device to record information about activity
microphone: equipment to record sound

h People were trying to study Blue 55's characteristics and habits. true / false
i Iris paid attention to the teacher after the video had finished. true / false
j In the end, Blue 55 stopped trying to communicate with the other whales. true / false

4 Work in pairs and correct all the false sentences.

5 Vocabulary: Match the marine wildlife words in blue to a definition.

a Very small plants and animals that bigger sea animals eat.
b A scientist who studies sea life.
c When animals travel to a different place.
d A group of whales.
e A very large area of sea.
f A safe place for animals.
g A group of animals that are very similar.
h A mixture of two very different things.

Language focus – Collective nouns
A collective noun is a group of specific things, for example, animals.
A pod of whales.

6 Can you match the collective nouns to the correct animals?

1 A herd of	a birds
2 A litter of	b lions
3 A pack of	c puppies
4 A flock of	d wolves
5 A pride of	e elephants

Reading tip
Look at writing style
Understand the message in a story by looking at the author's writing style.

7 Talk: Use the words in Activity 5 to answer the questions.

a What was special about Blue 55's parents?
b What did the marine biologists want to study about Blue 55?
c Find three things that made Blue 55 different from other whales. Why couldn't he communicate?

8 Read the Reading tip box. Why do you think the author refers to Blue 55 as 'he' instead of 'it'? How does she want the reader to feel about Blue 55?

9 How did Iris feel when she was watching the video? Which words give you clues about her emotions? Why do you think she felt like this?

10 Values: Feeling empathy.
Discuss the questions in pairs or in a small group.

a How did the story make you feel? Why?
b Iris had empathy with the whale. What do you think 'empathy' means? Choose the best definition.
1 When you can understand someone's feelings because you can imagine their situation.
2 When you love animals and nature.
3 When you have the same problem as someone else.
c Think about situations at school and in class. How can it help to have empathy at these times? Think of three examples and tell your class.

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c The whale swam around in a group with other whales. true / false

d The whale's mother and father were different species. true / false

e The whale had a song that sounded very different to the other whales. true / false

f The other whales could still understand him. true / false

g Blue 55's own mother and father probably couldn't understand him. true / false

h People were trying to study Blue 55's characteristics and habits. true / false

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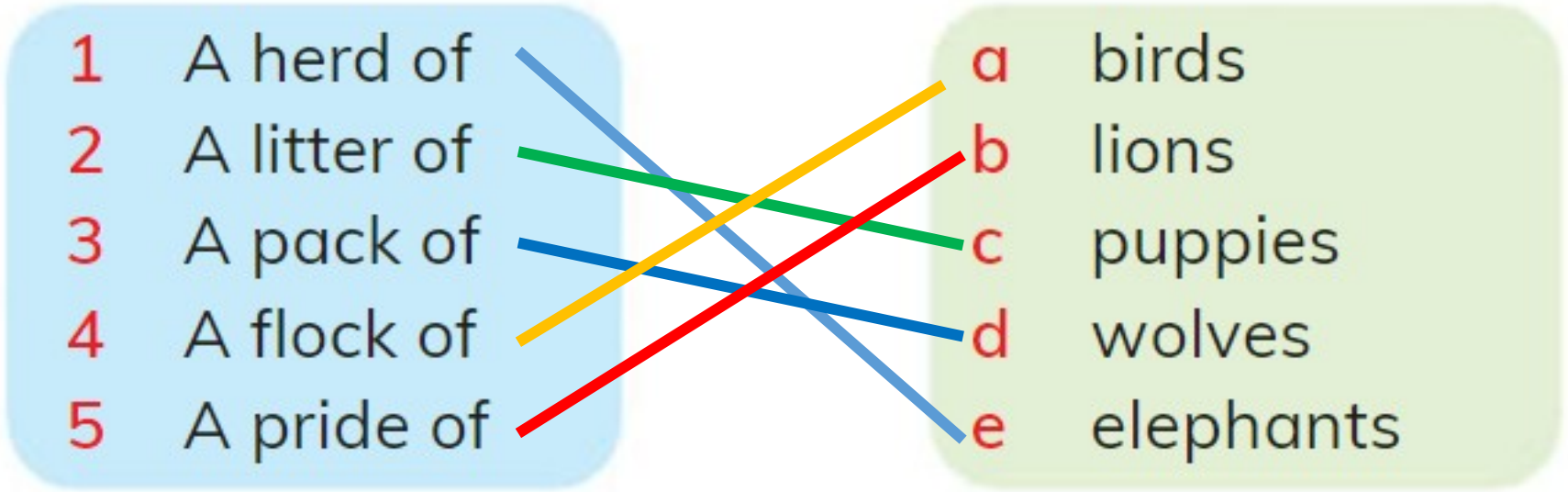
f A safe place for animals. **sanctuary**

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8 **Read the Reading tip box. Why do you think the author refers to Blue 55 as 'he' instead of 'it'? How does she want the reader to feel about Blue 55?**

9 **How did Iris feel when she was watching the video? Which words give you clues about her emotions? Why do you think she felt like this?**

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